

If we are to consider two mobile phone networks, not only the entire software set but also the overall networking methodologies might differ. So an attack method on one network does not guarantee that the same is going to work for another as well. So in effect diversity results in division of risk.

So we can vaguely answer the question of “Who would do that?” as “Multiple teams of skilled hackers”. Let’s move onto next point: the timing. The situation we imagined to backup the broad definition of Cyber-terrorism involves two or more systems going down at once. The new question is “Is it possible to take down two systems at once?” The answer to that question too would be ambiguous and difficult to answer in a plain yes or no.

Critical systems are protected by critical countermeasures developed by highly skilled professionals and experts. Chances to break through them are very low. If a security loophole is found out by a (team of) hacker(s), then the possibilities of exploitation of the loophole depend on the ethics of the hacker. If it was an ethical hacker, he would notify the system administra-



The movie Live Free or Die Hard is one of the best depictions of the broad definition of cyber-terrorism

tors. Also, maintainers of critical systems usually have a separate team for vulnerability testing which keeps attacking the system (with legal permission from the company) to test if it system could be attacked. If the hacker who found a way through was malicious, there are again two possibilities: i) He could create program(s) to exploit the vulnerability OR ii) coordinate with other hackers who already have found a bug in another critical system to launch a parallel attack on both of them.

Look back and you have certain conditions governing the possibility of takedown of two systems:

- ▶ Security research teams did not find a loophole.